

selves,¹ a great figure of mythical attributes, a master of magic and esoteric lore. This picture, drawn from the evidence supplied primarily by the classical writers,² may be used when we ask how much the Jews are likely to have taken from Parsism. If the Parsism they knew was after this model, certainly there was not much by which they could enrich their own religious treasury.

The Talmud states that the Jews "brought the names of the angels from Babylon," which tallies with the obvious contrast between the pre-exilic angelology and the detailed and ordered hierarchies of later Judaism. This elaborated doctrine of angels and spirits was an unmistakably new thing, as is shown by the refusal of the conservative Sadducees to accept it.³ I see no *a priori* reason for denying the possibility that Persian (that is, Magian) influence fostered the growth of this quasi-animistic angelology. It was never in the main stream of Jewish theology. Paul's attitude towards it is very suggestive. Meeting something essentially of the same kind at Colossæ, he took no trouble to endorse or deny its truth. Speculation about angels was for him purely idle, and worship of angels debased superstition: the only

¹ Rightly, as Prof. Jackson still thinks. On this subject see my remarks above, p. 197 f.

² "But I believe it to be fairly true, if you compare the Muhammadan writers of later times," writes Prof. Jackson. Does not their date alone make testimony on such matters almost valueless? But I need not repeat with how much diffidence I venture a view of Zarathushtra and the Magi which differs seriously from that of such an authority as my friend. I have stated my reasons elsewhere, and must leave my theories to sink or swim.

³ Acts 23⁸.